

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

Graduation

Week 38

Week of Jun 14–18

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 38 · Week Overview

Graduation
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

graduation

friend

thank you

grow

good-bye

📚 The last week of the year, and the one week that IS the review — still exactly ONE taught song: the old choruses come back as a memory game and a finale medley, never as new material. The Summer Solstice falls on 21 June, in the holiday.

Little's (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **"Bye-bye!"** (a big slow wave), **"Thank you!"** (hands together, a little bow), **"Big!"** (stretch tall on tiptoe).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"I am big now."**

"Thank you, teacher."

"Good-bye, my friends — I will come back!"

The week at a glance

MON	Look How We Grew	every child's first-day-of-school photograph, printed, one each, with the date written on the...
TUE	Cap and Certificate	one graduation cap with a tassel and one blank certificate (print pack page 17), in the Magic...
WED	Our Memory Box	the memory box
THU	Thank You + Our Songs	the ukulele itself, in the Magic Box if it fits and beside it if it doesn't, plus the year's s...
FRI	The Graduation Ceremony + the Whole Year	the certificates, names written in, one per child (print pack page 17); the caps; the class ph...

2 MIN

📦 Magic Box hook



4 MIN

📢 Teach the words



3 MIN

🎵 Song · today's verse



3 MIN

⚡ Game · move it



1 MIN

😊 Whisper-shout close

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

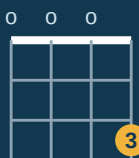
The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

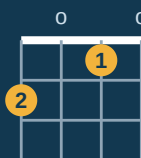
Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.



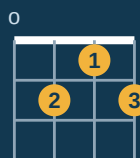
G C E A

C



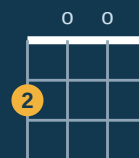
G C E A

F



G C E A

G7



G C E A

Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("we grew — so — big-ger"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — on Friday the parents are watching the children, not your right hand.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

Look How We Grew

Today's words: **grow**

Grab: every child's first-day-of-school photograph, printed, one each, with the date written on the back, in the Magic Box; a long paper strip per child for the growth timeline (Tray 1); the growing up card; the picture cards from print pack page 11.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is light and flat and it does not rattle at all. Hold it up. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — a soft paper slither. Lift the lid a crack, peek in for a long time, and let your face go slowly amazed.

TEACHER "There are some **very small people** in here... and I think I **know** them." (*draw out the first photograph and hold it against your chest, face hidden*)

Turn it round. One photograph at a time, held high, all the way round the circle. Do not name them — let the class do it. Then stretch up tall together: **"Big!"**

4 MIN TEACH · GROW

Everybody crouches down as small as they can go. We grow up twice — slow, then quick:

When I came here I was **THIS** small, (*crouch right down, head tucked in*)

I couldn't talk, I couldn't run, (*shake your head, hands over your mouth*)

Now look at me — I'm **THIS** tall, (*rise slowly and stretch up on tiptoe*)

And I can do it **ALL!** (*one big jump with both arms up*)

Then the photographs, properly. Hold one up beside the real child standing next to you and say the plain true thing, slowly: **this was you, in September**. You could not say "hello" in English. You are the same person, and you are not the same size, and nobody in this room stopped growing for one single day.

LITTLES crouch and stretch and say **"Big!"** **BIGS** take the frame: **"I am big now." "I was little in September."**

Teacher fails: hold up the smallest photograph, look hard at it, then hold it next to **your own** face. "Ah. This is me." Nod seriously. Hold it. Wait for the roar.

Chinese moment: lay the **growing up** card in the middle of the mat and say **You have grown up!** once, all together. Leave the card there; the row grows by one card a day and on Friday the whole year is on the mat: growing up · graduation · friend · thank you · goodbye.

3 MIN GAME · THEN & NOW

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The photographs are face down in a basket in the middle of the circle.

TEACHER "Take one... look at it... now **find that person** and give it to them."

One child at a time: pick, look, walk round the circle, and hand the photograph to the child in it with two hands. **LITTLES** get shown two photographs and point at the right friend — a full win. **BIGS** say it as they hand it over: **"This is you. You were little!"**

Nobody gets their own. That is the whole game: to find your photograph you have to be **found**, by a friend.

Keep the photographs out afterwards — they go straight onto Tray 1, the growth timeline, with the date on the back as the control. They stay on the shelf all week and go home in Friday's folder.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in a ring, crouched right down and ready. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "We were so small... now we are **SO BIG!**" (*crouch tiny on the whisper · rise on the normal voice · jump up with both arms on the SHOUT*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Leo the Late Bloomer* (Robert Kraus) — Leo can't do anything at all, until one day he can. It is the kindest book in the world for the child who is still catching up, and this is the week to read it.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WE GREW SO BIG chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C We were so small, and **F** now we're **SO** **C** big! (*crouch tiny, then stretch tall*)

Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! (*everybody jumps*)

C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, (*hands together, bow both ways*)

Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! (*arms wide*)

MONDAY · GROW

C Little, little, little me, (*crouch smaller on each "little"*)

G7 Now I'm big **C** as big can be! (*shoot up onto tiptoe, arms right up*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole thing on Friday. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. Sing it standing in a ring, holding hands, every single day.

TUESDAY

Cap and Certificate

Today's words: **graduation** (*grow comes back every day*)

Grab: one **graduation cap** with a tassel and one **blank certificate** (print pack page 17), in the Magic Box; a chair or a mat square that marks "the front"; the caps for the whole class if you have them, still in their bag; the graduation card; yesterday's photographs on Tray 1.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

There are exactly two things in the box today: one is flat and one is square with something dangling off it. Chant first:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Tip the box gently — a slide, then a swing. Lift the lid and take out the **certificate** first, holding it flat in both hands like something precious.

TEACHER "This is a **paper**... and it has somebody's **name** on it. Whose name do you think?" (*take out the cap, put it on your head, and let the tassel swing*)

Both hands on their own heads: "**Graduation!**"

4 MIN TEACH • GRADUATION

Everybody stands. We put the cap on twice — slow and careful, then proud:

Cap on my head, (*both hands lower an imaginary cap onto your head*)

Tassel on the side, (*flick two fingers beside your ear, swinging*)

Walk to the **front**, (*four big marching steps on the spot*)

and stand up with **PRIDE!** (*stop, feet together, back straight, chin up*)

Then explain it once, plainly, because most of them have never heard the word: **graduation is the day we say you are finished**. You came, you stayed the whole year, you learned all of it — and on Friday everybody watches you walk to the front on your own and take your paper. Nobody has to be brave. We are going to practise it until it is easy.

LITTLES pat their heads and say "**Graduation!**" **BIGS** owe you the sentence: "**I am big now.**" "**On Friday I walk to the front.**"

Teacher fails: put the cap on **backwards**, with the tassel hanging straight down over your nose, and try to read the certificate through it. Blow the tassel out of the way. Try again. Wait.

Chinese moment: the **graduation** card joins growing up on the mat — **We are graduating!** shouted once at full volume, both arms up. Then **graduation cap** as the cap goes round the circle and every single child wears it for three seconds.

3 MIN GAME • GRADUATION PARADE PRACTICE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Mark "the front" with a chair. Four steps, and the class says them out loud with you each time: **walk • stop • bow • cap on**.

TEACHER (*call one name at a time, exactly as you will on Friday*) "...and now — **Mei-mei!**" (*everybody claps until she is back in her place*)

Every child goes once. **LITTLES** walk it holding a friend's hand and that is how they will do it on Friday too — decide it now, not on the day. **BIGS** go alone and take the pretend certificate with **two hands**: "**Thank you!**"

Clap for every single child, exactly the same amount. They are counting, and they will remember for years who got the loudest clap.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in a ring, caps on (real or imaginary). Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "We were so small... now we are SO BIG!" (*crouch tiny • rise • jump up with both arms on the SHOUT, tassels flying*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Oh, the Places You'll Go!* (Dr Seuss) — read two spreads only, not the whole thing, and read them slowly. Save the rest for Friday.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT • WE GREW SO BIG chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C We were so small, and **F** now we're SO **C** big! (*crouch tiny, then stretch tall*)

Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! (*everybody jumps*)

C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, (*hands together, bow both ways*)

Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! (*arms wide*)

TUESDAY • GRADUATION

C Cap on my head and a smile so wide, (*hands on head, then draw a big smile*)

G7 Walk to the front **C** with a little pride! (*four proud steps, then stand still*)

Sing this verse *marching*, the whole class walking the circle in a slow line, and stop dead on the last word. The stopping is the bit they need for Friday; the song is just how we practise it without anybody feeling watched.

WEDNESDAY

Our Memory Box

Today's words: **friend** (grow · graduation come back every day)

Grab: the **memory box** — a globe, a dinosaur, a rocket, a bird's nest, a red envelope and a pinwheel — one object per big stretch of the year; a cloth to cover it; the month cards for Tray 2; the friend card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box is **heavy** and it rattles like a whole cupboard. Carry it in with both arms. Chant:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it once — an enormous clatter — and look alarmed at the noise you just made. Then lift out one thing at a time and say nothing at all.

TEACHER (hold up the globe, then the dinosaur, then the rocket, in complete silence) "...we **did** all of this."

Every object goes into the middle of the mat. Hands to the temples, remembering: "**I remember!**"

4 MIN TEACH · FRIEND · REMEMBER

Everybody sits round the six objects. Say it twice, and the second time they say it with you:

Do you **remember?** (both hands to your temples, eyes shut)

Yes — **I do!** (eyes open wide, one finger up)

A star, a dinosaur, a **seed** that grew... (point up · stomp · hands opening like a flower)

and best of all — **YOU!** (point at the friend beside you)

Now take each object round the circle and let them tell **you**: the **globe** is when we found all seven continents and sat on the map; the **dinosaur** is when we dug for fossils; the **rocket** is blast off; the **nest** is where the bird lives; the **red envelope** is Chinese New Year; the **pinwheel** is the windy day. Then say the true thing: not one of those days happened on your own. You did every single one of them **with your friends**.

LITTLES hold one object and name it — "**Rocket!**" **BIGS** give the sentence: "**You are my friend.**" "**I remember the dinosaurs!**"

Teacher fails: pick up the bird's nest, look at it blankly and guess: "A hat? Is it a little hat?" Put it on your head. Wait to be corrected, loudly, by everybody at once.

Chinese moment: the **friend** card joins the row — **good friend**. Then everybody turns to the child beside them, takes both their hands and says it: **You are my good friend**. Tomorrow we thank the teachers; today we thank each other.

3 MIN GAME · MEMORY-BOX GUESSING

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The six objects go back in the box under the cloth. One child at a time, **eyes closed**, hand in.

TEACHER "No looking... feel it... **what is it** — and **when** did we do it?" (the whole circle waits; nobody shouts the answer)

Naming it before seeing it is the work; naming the *month* is the extra step for the bigs. **LITTLES** feel it and give one word: "**Rocket!**"

BIGS give both: "**A rocket — that was May!**" Then out it comes and everybody sees.

Put the same object back in twice on purpose. A child who feels the nest a second time and names it instantly, without stopping to think, has just shown you that the word is theirs for good.

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in a ring, holding the hands of the friends on either side. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "We were so small... now we are **SO BIG!**" (crouch tiny together · rise together · all the arms go up together on the **SHOUT**, hands still joined)

Got 3 spare minutes? *My Friend Is Sad* (Mo Willems) — two friends, almost no words, and every child in the room can read the faces. Let them do the voices.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WE GREW SO BIG chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C We were so small, and **F** now we're **SO** **C** big! (crouch tiny, then stretch tall)

Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! (everybody jumps)

C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, (hands together, bow both ways)

Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! (arms wide)

WEDNESDAY · REMEMBER

C Stars and dinosaurs, seeds and snow, (point up · stomp · hands opening · falling fingers)

G7 All the things **C** we got to know! (sweep both hands round the circle)

Four gestures, four whole months of the year in one line. Do them very slowly the first time and let somebody shout out what each one was — that shouting is the review, and it costs you nothing.

THURSDAY

Thank You + Our Songs

Today's words: **thank you** (grow · graduation · friend come back every day)

Grab: the **ukulele itself**, in the Magic Box if it fits and beside it if it doesn't, plus the year's **song-title cards** (Tray 3); the thank-you card materials for Tray 4 — folded card, a model, glue, paper flowers; the thank you card; the memory box still out on Tray 2.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box will not shut, because the ukulele is sticking out of it. Carry it in that way, seriously, as if you had not noticed. Chant:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Shake it — and the strings go *brrrring* all by themselves. Look at the box, astonished. Shake it again.

TEACHER "This box is **SINGING**." (*lift the ukulele out and hold it up; strum one slow chord and say nothing*)

Then the song-title cards, fanned out like a hand of cards. Hands together, a little bow: **"Thank you!"**

4 MIN TEACH · THANK YOU

Everybody stands. Say it twice — once quietly to one person, once out loud to the whole room:

Thank you for the songs, (*hands together, bow to the ukulele*)

Thank you for the days, (*bow to the window*)

Thank you, all my friends, (*turn on the spot, bowing all the way round*)

in a hundred **different ways!** (*both arms thrown wide*)

Then the real thing, and take your time over it. Ask them who they want to thank — and take every answer: the cleaning auntie, the cook, the driver, the teacher who plaits their hair, a friend who shared a bike. Write the names down as they say them; that list is who Tray 4's thank-you cards get made for. Say it plainly: **thank you** is two words that you say *to somebody's face*, and this week we are going to say it to everybody who helped us.

LITTLES put their hands together and bow: **"Thank you!"** **BIGS** owe you the whole line: **"Thank you, teacher."** **"Thank you for the year with you."**

Teacher fails: hold the ukulele the wrong way round, strum the back of it with great feeling, and look puzzled when nothing happens. Turn it upside down and try again. Wait.

Chinese moment: the **thank you** card joins the row — **thank you teacher, thank you friends**, said with the bow. Then tell them about tomorrow: Li Bai wrote a poem for a friend who came to sing him good-bye — **"To Wang Lun"** — and we will say its last line at the ceremony: *Peach Blossom Pool is a thousand feet deep, but not as deep as my friend's love as he sees me off.*

1 MIN CLOSE

Standing in a ring, hands together ready to bow. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "We were so small... now we are SO BIG!" (*crouch tiny · rise · jump with both arms up on the SHOUT, then one last bow to each other*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Thank You, Omu!* (Oge Mora) — everybody takes a little of the stew, and then everybody brings something back. Read it just before the thank-you cards go on the shelf.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WE GREW SO BIG chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C We were so small, and **F** now we're SO **C** big! (*crouch tiny, then stretch tall*)

Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! (*everybody jumps*)

C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, (*hands together, bow both ways*)

Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! (*arms wide*)

THURSDAY · THANK YOU

C Thank you, teacher, thank you true, (*hands together, a deep bow*)

G7 Thank you for **C** the year with you! (*both hands out to the whole room*)

Sing this one *quietly*. It is the only quiet verse in the song and it is the one the parents will remember on Friday, so do not let it get shouted. Straight back into the big chorus afterwards.

FRIDAY

The Graduation Ceremony + the Whole Year

Today's words: **good-bye** — and **graduation** · **friend** · **thank you** · **grow**, the whole week, and the whole year

Grab: the **certificates**, names written in, one per child (print pack page 17); the caps; the class photograph plan (who stands where); **every prop of the year** laid out along the mat in order, September on the left; the ukulele; the thank-you cards the children made; the goodbye card; tissues for the parents. **Today runs long** — the ceremony is not squeezed into 13 minutes.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out bulging and will not close, and the whole year is laid out on the mat behind it.

TEACHER "Today the box is **FULL** — it has our whole **YEAR** inside it!"

Pull each thing out and hold it up in complete silence. They will supply the word before you can.

The photograph → "**Little me!**" The cap → "**Graduation!**" The memory box → "**I remember!**" The ukulele → "**Thank you!**"

Last of all, one small thing left in the bottom: a **certificate** with a real name on it. Read the name out. Then wave it, slowly, high. "**GOOD-BYE!**"

4 MIN TEACH · GOOD-BYE, THEN THE WHOLE YEAR

Everybody stands. We tell the whole week with our bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

I was so **little**, (*crouch right down*)

Now I've **grown**, (*rise onto tiptoe*)

Graduation day — (*both hands lower the cap onto your head*)

Thank you, friends, (*hands together, bow all the way round*)

Good-bye — but not for long! (*a big slow wave, then both arms wide*)

Then walk the mat, September to June, and let them name it: I'm special · my body · five senses · feelings · autumn · food · family · my house · plants · helpers · Christmas · winter · Beijing · China · Chinese New Year · the continents · the oceans · Africa · spring · habitats · the Earth · the universe · the solar system · space · dinosaurs · summer. Say the true thing at the end of the walk: **you did all of that**, and in September you could not say "hello".

LITTLES do the five gestures and shout the five words. **BIGS** owe you a whole sentence each: "**I am big now.**" "**Thank you, teacher.**" "**Good-bye, my friends — I will come back!**"

Teacher fails: start handing out the certificates to the **parents** instead, very solemnly, shaking each of them by the hand. Keep going until the children stop you.

Chinese moment: the **goodbye** card completes the row — growing up · graduation · friend · thank you · goodbye, the whole week on the mat. Say "**To Wang Lun**"'s last line together, slowly: *Peach Blossom Pool is a thousand feet deep, but not as deep as my friend's love as he sees me off.* A friend came down to the water to sing good-bye, and the poet never forgot it.

That is exactly what today is. Then, all together: **Goodbye teacher! Goodbye friends!**

3 MIN GAME · THE GRADUATION CEREMONY

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Caps on. Everybody sits in the ring; the parents sit behind. Exactly what we practised on Tuesday: **walk · stop · bow · cap on.**

TEACHER (*one name at a time, said clearly and slowly*) "...and now — **Mei-mei!**" (*she walks, takes the certificate with two hands, bows, and everybody claps until she is back*)

LITTLES walk it holding a friend's hand, exactly as agreed on Tuesday. **BIGS** go alone, take it with two hands and say it out loud: "**Thank you!**" Every child hands their **thank-you card** to the person they made it for on the way back.

Then the **class photograph**, everybody in, teachers included — and one silly one straight afterwards.

Same clap for every child, and read every name slowly enough to get it right. Somebody in this room will remember this two minutes for thirty years.

1 MIN CLOSE + CERTIFICATES

Standing in the ring, certificates held in two hands, caps on. All five gestures, one last time:

EVERYONE "We were so small... now we are **SO BIG!**" (*crouch right down on the whisper · rise on the normal voice · every arm and every certificate up on the SHOUT*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Kissing Hand* (Audrey Penn) — the good-bye book, and the one that lets a child cry about it without anybody making a fuss. Then send them out of the door with their folder: photographs, timeline strip, worksheet, certificate.

› **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · WE GREW SO BIG** Friday's verse, then the **WHOLE** song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C We were so small, and **F** now we're **SO C** big! (*crouch tiny, then stretch tall*)

Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! (*everybody jumps*)

C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, (*hands together, bow both ways*)

Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! (*arms wide*)

FRIDAY · GOOD-BYE

C Good-bye, good-bye — but not for long! (*a big slow wave*)

G7 We'll come back **C** and sing our song! (*point at the door, then arms wide*)

Then the medley — the review of the year. One chorus each, in order, no verses: *Where Do You Live?* → *This Is My Earth* → *Up the Mountain, Down the River* → *Love the Earth* → *The Big Bang Boom* → *Round and Round* → *Blast Off!* → *Dinosaur Stomp* → *Dig, Dig, Dig* → *Summer, Summer, Sunny Day* — and straight back into the "We Grew So Big" chorus to finish. Hold the song-title cards up as you go so nobody is lost; if a chorus has gone, skip it and keep moving.

★ We Grew So Big

Week 38 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday, then the year's medley.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** We were so small, and **F** now we're SO **C** big! *(crouch tiny, then stretch tall)*
Am Look how we **C** grew — let's **G7** dance a **C** jig! *(everybody jumps)*
C Thank you, teachers, **F** thank you, **C** friends, *(hands together, bow both ways)*
Am Sing our **C** song — it **G7** never **C** ends! *(arms wide)*

MONDAY · GROW

- C** Little, little, little me, *(crouch smaller on each “little”)*
G7 Now I'm big **C** as big can be! *(shoot up onto tiptoe, arms right up)*

TUESDAY · GRADUATION

- C** Cap on my head and a smile so wide, *(hands on head, then draw a big smile)*
G7 Walk to the front **C** with a little pride! *(four proud steps, then stand still)*

WEDNESDAY · REMEMBER

- C** Stars and dinosaurs, seeds and snow, *(point up · stomp · hands opening · falling fingers)*
G7 All the things **C** we got to know! *(sweep both hands round the circle)*

THURSDAY · THANK YOU

- C** Thank you, teacher, thank you true, *(hands together, a deep bow)*
G7 Thank you for **C** the year with you! *(both hands out to the whole room)*

FRIDAY · GOOD-BYE

- C** Good-bye, good-bye — but not for long! *(a big slow wave)*
G7 We'll come back **C** and sing our song! *(point at the door, then arms wide)*

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“we grew — so — big-ger”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — on Friday the parents are watching the children, not your right hand.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **Am** → **G7** → **C**. That is the entire chorus, and every verse is just C and G7. C is one finger, Am is one finger, F is two, G7 is three; learn them in that order and leave G7 till last. If your fingers get stuck on Friday of all days, put the uke down, hold the class photograph up instead and do the finger-play: the actions carry the meaning either way, and after a whole year they will sing it without you.